Notice the 200 response code, which means "OK" in the context of a GET request. But is this really OK? Imagine if index.php was supposed to return the homepage of your shiny website? What if there's a response code for this situation, where the server is telling us off for not using the correct method token? In fact there is – 405 Method Not Allowed – so let's add that in too…

```
$method = $_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'];

if ($method !== 'GET') {
    http_response_code(405);
    print "HTTP request method not allowed: {$method}" . PHP_EOL;
} else {
    http_response_code(200);
    print "HTTP request method: {$method}" . PHP_EOL;
}
```

… and now when we run curl -X 'PUT' http://localhost:8080/index.php and check the cli-server log, we see this:

```
[...] 172.17.0.1:60330 [405]: PUT /index.php
```

By using PHP's built-in http_response_code() function, we can set the status of the response message: 405 Method Not Allowed if the method isn't GET; otherwise, 200 OK. And, importantly, we as engineers are a step closer to being responsible citizens of the internet. Users often don't get to see HTTP statuses, but machines always do. Anyone using your web application to power their own will thank you for taking the time to properly indicate what went on inside your systems or will at least complain if you don't!

The vast majority of the time you'll be dealing with GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE. Choosing which method(s) to implement for a particular resource should be a matter of what happens to the resource in the event of a successful request, and getting that choice right means you'll have an HTTP interface that is logical and easy to use elsewhere. To aid in the choosing, it is necessary to give some thought to a key feature of HTTP methods: *idempotence*.

Idempotence

Have you ever experienced a social media platform (or an online forum, if you're as old as me) creating two comments or posts despite only ever hitting the save button once? A common scenario is that the server was able to create the new resource but did not